

30-60-90 Day Operational Plan

Establishing the minimum viable operating system for Deerfield Intelligence

Day 90 north star

By day 90, Deerfield Intelligence has a minimum viable operating system that makes work and decisions visible, enables reliable commitments, supports hiring and onboarding, and gives recurring corporate workflows a clear path. The system should reduce dependence on individual memory and senior-leader intervention without importing heavyweight process into a ten-person team.

Operating principles

- **Prioritize leverage.** Address the mechanisms that remove several downstream symptoms before optimizing isolated workflows.
- **Start lightweight.** Use a small number of required fields, templates and forums; add process only when evidence shows it is needed.
- **Limit work in progress.** Run no more than three substantial builds at once and treat the six P1 issues as two integrated agendas.
- **Keep specialist authority with specialist functions.** Operations owns orchestration, visibility and follow-through, not Legal, Compliance, HR, Finance or technical judgment.

The plan deliberately combines four types of intervention:

1. Lightweight processes for recurring work
2. Systems that create visibility and control
3. Operating rituals that force timely decisions
4. Quick wins that reduce immediate friction and risk.

The first 30 days bias toward quick wins and visibility. Days 31–60 turn those mechanisms into repeatable processes. Days 61–90 embed ownership, rituals and measurement.

Prioritization and capacity

A credible plan requires explicit tradeoffs

The issue register contains 31 distinct gaps. Attempting to solve each one separately would create a new Operations bottleneck and encourage shallow implementation. The plan therefore concentrates the first 90 days on five workstreams, with only three active builds at any point.

Band	Count	Treatment	Capacity implication
P1 Critical	6 issues	Begin immediately	Two integrated agendas: portfolio control and hiring with onboarding
P2 High	14 issues	Selectively start or triage	Choose quick safeguards and foundational workflows; defer policy-heavy implementation
P3 Medium	5 issues	Post 90 days	Start after portfolio data and ownership foundations exist
P4 Longer term	6 issues	Post 90 days	Requires stronger evidence, broader sponsorship or firm-wide policy change

Five workstreams

	Workstream	Issues addressed	Primary window
1	Portfolio control and delivery reliability	PIP-01, PMO-01, XPD-01, CAP-01	0 to 30 days
2	Hiring and onboarding readiness	HIR-01, ONB-01, ONB-02	0 to 30 days
3	Immediate vendor and spend safeguards	VEN-01, FIN-02	0 to 30 days
4	Operating ownership and project initiation	ORG-01, SCP-01, PCE-01, WFP-01	31 to 60 days
5	Core corporate workflows	CORP-01, CORP-02, CORP-03, FIN-01	61 to 90 days

What lightweight means in practice

Area	Use first	Avoid initially
Portfolio system	✓ One maintained list with required fields and a decision cadence	x New enterprise project-management platform
Capacity view	✓ Allocation bands and major constraints	x Detailed time tracking
Decision rights	✓ Workflow-level owner, approver and escalation path	x Organization-wide RACI for every activity
Controls	✓ Risk tiers, triggers and interim safeguards	x Uniform review for every experiment
Reporting	✓ A few measures tied to decisions	x A broad KPI dashboard before data ownership is stable

Days 0 to 30

Deliver quick wins, create visibility and stabilize critical workflows

The first month **prioritizes quick wins** that create immediate visibility, remove avoidable friction and reduce near-term operational risk while establishing the foundation for more durable workflows. The goal is working mechanisms—not a perfect target operating model.

Focus	Actions	Deliverables	Exit measure
Portfolio control	Inventory every material initiative; define required fields; create one intake; identify blocked work; launch a weekly decision forum.	Current portfolio view; intake form; decision log; initial capacity bands	100 percent of material active work has an owner, status, next milestone and known dependency
Cross-pod commitments	Review active dependencies; require acceptance by the supplying pod before an external date is confirmed.	Dependency field and acceptance rule embedded in the portfolio view	No new cross-pod date is promised without an accepted owner and date
Hiring and onboarding	Baseline the recruiting funnel; confirm active roles; reserve interview panels; document day-one access and escalation; create a 30-day plan template.	Search tracker; interview plan; role-based access checklist; first-month template	Every active search has an owner and timeline; upcoming hires have a pre-start plan
Spend safeguards	Assemble the vendor and contract inventory; assign business owners; flag near-term renewals; implement basic cloud burn and anomaly visibility.	Vendor register; renewal calendar; weekly cloud-cost review	All known vendors have an owner and renewal date; material cloud spikes are investigated promptly

Key decisions required

- David and the pod leads agree who can accept, defer or displace work and which exceptions still require CIO involvement.
- HR, IT and hiring managers agree on the owner and timing for pre-start provisioning and technical setup.
- Finance and technical owners provide the contract, payment and cloud data required for the initial safeguards.

Days 31 to 60

Turn the initial mechanisms into repeatable ways of working

Once visibility exists, the second month should define how work begins and who decides. This phase adds only the minimum structure required to prevent rework, unowned handoffs and repeated escalation.

Focus	Actions	Deliverables	Exit measure
Operating ownership	Define the execution owner, specialist approver and escalation path for the highest-frequency cross-boundary workflows.	Decision-rights map for priority workflows	Routine coordination no longer defaults to David or pod leaders
Project initiation	Introduce a one-page charter covering objective, sponsor, scope, required inputs, dependencies, definition of done and transition path.	Project charter and launch gate	New material projects begin with agreed scope and completion criteria
Portfolio company handoff	Set minimum sponsor and portfolio company responsibilities, including counterpart, data access, decisions and escalation.	Engagement brief and mutual-responsibility checklist	New engagements start with a named sponsor and company counterpart
Workforce plan	Translate the portfolio and capacity view into an 18-month role sequence with triggers, cost, reporting lines and dependencies.	Sequenced workforce plan	Each planned role has a documented business rationale and start trigger
Vendor fast path design	Agree risk tiers, submission requirements, approval thresholds and visible stages for suppliers and data sources.	Approved minimum workflow ready to launch	Routine requests have a proportionate path; exceptions are explicit

Review before adding process

At day 45, review whether the first-month mechanisms are being used and changing decisions. Remove fields, meetings or templates that do not support a clear decision, handoff or control. The goal is to improve reliability with the smallest sustainable operating burden.

Days 61 to 90

Embed the core workflows measure adoption and transfer routine ownership

The final month should make the system durable. Operations should refine the mechanisms based on actual use, transfer routine upkeep to the right owners and define the next wave without becoming the permanent coordinator for every transaction.

Focus	Actions	Deliverables	Exit measure
Corporate workflows	Launch the vendor fast path; add project and data-use triggers for Legal and Compliance; define the ongoing IT and SecOps request path.	Published intake requirements, stages, owners and escalation routes	Common requests use a standard route and visible owner
Financial planning	Start a monthly financial pulse and rolling six-month outlook tied to headcount, cloud, vendors and major roadmap choices.	Initial forecast and variance review	Finance has forward visibility on material commitments and changes
Operating cadence	Evaluate weekly and monthly forums; clarify decisions; remove redundant status reporting; assign update ownership to pod leads and workflow owners.	Final cadence and ownership map	Forums resolve decisions and exceptions rather than collect updates
Adoption and measures	Track completion, decision speed, onboarding readiness, dependency acceptance, renewal exposure and cloud anomalies.	Small operational scorecard	Measures have named owners and are used in the operating review
Next wave	Confirm which deferred controls and capabilities move into the following two quarters, based on validated risk, evidence and available specialist capacity.	Six-to-twelve-month backlog and sponsor commitments	Post-90 priorities have owners, prerequisites and an agreed order

Day 90 ownership test

The system is working only if pod leads and functional counterparts can maintain it without Operations chasing every update. Operations should own the design, standards and exception process; routine data and workflow steps should sit with the people closest to the work.

Roadmap and success measures

The first 90 days establish the foundation rather than complete every build

Day 90 success measures

Outcome	Measure
Portfolio control	All material active initiatives have an owner, objective, status, next milestone, dependencies and escalation path; all new demand enters one queue.
Delivery reliability	Cross-pod commitments have accepted owners and dates before external promises are made; unresolved dependencies are reviewed weekly.
Hiring and onboarding	Every active search has a committed plan and owner; each new hire has baseline access, a first-week task and a documented 30-day plan.
Vendor and spend visibility	Active vendors have owners, costs and renewal dates; cloud anomalies trigger named follow-up during the month.
Operating ownership	Priority recurring workflows have an execution owner, specialist approver and escalation path.
Corporate-function routing	Common vendor, Legal, Compliance, ongoing access and financial-planning requests use documented paths with visible status.
Deferred risk	Material post-90 control gaps have named owners, interim safeguards and an agreed implementation sequence.

Evidence of success

The strongest signal will be fewer surprise escalations and less time spent reconstructing status or routing routine requests. Those outcomes should be tested through the portfolio review, recruiting and onboarding data, vendor and cloud records, and short feedback from pod leads and functional counterparts.

Post-90-day priorities

Important work deferred to protect focus and sequence prerequisites

Deferral does not mean the issue is unimportant. It means full implementation would either crowd out the critical operating foundation, depends on information created during the first 90 days, or requires specialist authority and broader firm sponsorship. Material risk should still be triaged early.

Priority	Issues	Why deferred and interim treatment
Regulatory accountability for portfolio deployments	PCE-02	Requires Legal and Compliance policy decisions, deployment inventory and standard terms. Complete risk triage and ownership first; build the formal framework next.
Access evidence and sensitive-data governance	IAM-01, DPG-01	High importance, but the full control design depends on authoritative system and data inventories and specialist standards. Apply interim restrictions to urgent exposures.
Model governance lifecycle	MDL-01	Start after the model population and risk scope are agreed. Focus first on investment-relevant production models rather than designing a universal framework.
Product support and shared technical foundations	PLC-01, PLT-01	Needs product and service inventories, technical-owner capacity and architecture choices. These builds should follow the portfolio and ownership foundations.
Cost-to-outcome visibility	BVC-01	Requires stable project identifiers, material-cost tagging and credible outcome measures. Building it earlier would create false precision.
Leadership structure and management capacity	WFP-02	Depends on the workforce plan and evidence from delegated operating mechanisms. Test the flat model before adding management layers.
Career levels titles pay bands and retention exceptions	WFP-03, WFP-04, ORG-03	Important for long-term talent competitiveness but requires broader firm policy, market benchmarking and relationship capital.
Office expectations and performance management	HIR-02, ORG-02	Validate candidate impact and employee needs before seeking policy changes. Address after hiring and role expectations are more stable.
Broader investment-organization integration	INT-01	Current evidence is limited and the solution is unclear. Validate with Investment Partners before adding forums or communication requirements.

Post-90 sequencing principle

Reassess the backlog at day 75 using current risk, evidence, specialist capacity and dependencies. Start the smallest viable next build and keep the same work-in-progress discipline used during the first 90 days.